



Link to Site: <https://www.toyotacenter.com/>

Participants:

Three characteristics my participants share are:

- 18 years of age or older
- Goes to concerts and events often
- Lives in Houston

These characteristics are the target audience of the website:

Adults living in Houston who want to attend concerts and live events.

Participants will be found through messages and texts towards close friends and relatives who match the criteria. Word-of-mouth will also be a notable method used. I am using people close to me as it is the most convenient and efficient way to conduct tests in a timely manner. I will also scout possible participants from classmates as well.

Participants Found:

- Classmate 1 (22 years old)
- Classmate 2 (20 years old)
- Classmate 3 (19 years old)

Objectives:

To define a metric assessing the user-friendliness of the site and identify areas for improvement.

- How easily can the users navigate the site? Do they get lost?
- Are there any difficulties or issues while trying to navigate?
- Can the participants achieve their desired action quickly?
- Does the page design convey clarity? Is it easily comprehensible and legible?

Tasks:

- **Signing Up:** “Create an account and sign up for the website.”
 - **Solution:** Click the “Insider Signup” red button in the upper right of the homepage, and proceed to fill out the following fields.
- **Search for Events:** “Look for an upcoming event happening this week.”
 - **Solution:** Clicking on “Events & Tickets” on the top of the page will lead you to upcoming events. Also, the homepage spotlights these events as well.
- **Buying Tickets:** “How would you buy tickets to this event?”
 - **Solution:** Clicking on the Event and then ‘Find Tickets’ will lead you to start the buying process. You can also hover over ‘Events & Tickets’ and click on ‘How to Buy Tickets’ under the pop-up menu.
- **Directions for Seats:** “Search for information about the venue’s seating chart.”
 - **Solution:** Hover the mouse over ‘Events & Tickets’ at the top of the homepage and click on the ‘Seating Charts’ option on the pop-up menu. Another option is to click on the event selected and then proceed to click the ‘View Seating Chart’ option to the right.
- **Finding Assistance:** “Where would you go to contact the venue?”
 - **Solution:** Hover the mouse over ‘Connect With Us’ at the top of the homepage and click on the ‘Contact Us’ option on the pop-up menu. There is also a ‘Connect With Us’ section at the very bottom of the homepage.

Tasks will be held using an iPhone stopwatch timer as well as Discord Screen Share if the participants were not tested in person.

Opening Script:

“Hello, and thank you for your participation in the usability test for the Houston Toyota Center website, where it is designed to assist users in searching for events and all things that occur in the arena. I will assess the website's functionality and design in terms of user navigation and communication. It's important to clarify that you, as the user, are not being tested; rather, we are evaluating the website's design and features. I will guide you through five tasks, recording the time for each, and welcome any relevant feedback you may have. If you have no questions, we can proceed and begin the testing.”

Results:

Task 1: Signing Up	
Times	Notes
Classmate 1: 9.83 seconds Classmate 2: 9.51 seconds Classmate 3: 57.63 seconds	• Classmate 1 mentioned, "They should just change this to 'Sign Up,'" referring to the 'Insider Signup' button after mistakenly clicking 'Login' first. • Classmate 2 immediately clicked the 'Insider Signup' button and was led to the sign up page. • Classmate 3 started by clicking the 'Login' button instead of 'Insider Signup.' This led to confusion and longer time taken before the user could get to the Sign Up page.
The biggest issue that I found from all the participants is that there was confusion between the 'Insider Signup' and 'Login' buttons as they were right next to each other. Also, most times, the login page has a 'Create an Account' link underneath, which confused the participants as there was none. I recommend the website to change 'Insider Signup' to just 'Sign up' as it is more clear for users.	
Task 2: Search for Events	
Times	Notes
Classmate 1: 11.81 seconds Classmate 2: 5.08 seconds Classmate 3: 10.31 seconds	• Classmate 1 looked around the homepage before clicking on the advertised event for this week. • Classmate 2 immediately clicked the first advertised event on the homepage, as its date was this week. • Classmate 3 scrolled down the homepage of the website and clicked on the advertised events happening this week.
This task was accomplished smoothly by all participants, as the homepage showcased upcoming events, as well as having 'Events & Tickets' lead users to an 'Upcoming Events' page.	

Task 3: Buying Tickets	
Times	Notes
Classmate 1: 14.71 seconds Classmate 2: 18.88 seconds Classmate 3: 15.46 seconds	- Classmate 1 clicked on the event again and proceeded to press the 'Find Tickets' button. - Classmate 2 clicked on the 'More Info' button on the event advertised, and proceeded to click 'Find Tickets.' - Classmate 3 clicked the 'More Info & Ticket Options' on the homepage next to the event.
Buying tickets was seemingly easy for users as they all knew where to find the event they were looking to buy tickets for. They all were interested in the 'More Info' or 'Find Tickets' buttons as they were colored bright red, catching their attention immediately.	
Task 4: Directions for Seats	
Times	Notes
Classmate 1: 27.15 seconds Classmate 2: 54.32 seconds Classmate 3: 36.13 seconds	- Classmate 1 hovered over the options in the header on the top ('Arena Info', 'Book Your Event', etc.) before settling on 'Events & Tickets', where he selected 'Seating Charts' in the menu. - Classmate 2 went to the virtual reality seating map for the Houston Rockets Court, instead of the needed seat map. After the confusion, Friend 1 clicked on the 'Events & Tickets' menu, where 'Seating Charts' was selected. - Classmate 3 was on the event prior, and selected the 'View Seating Chart' button under the 'Find Tickets' menu.
This task took longer for all participants compared to other ones. Classmates 2 and 3 found a seating chart by selecting the event once more, and clicking the option under the tickets menu. Classmate 1 was the only one to find it under 'Events & Tickets' after looking around. I recommend the website to use a more clear label and header for users to find the maps of the seating charts.	

Task 5: Finding Assistance	
Times	Notes
Classmate 1: 3.58 seconds Classmate 2: 4.96 seconds Classmate 3: 6.21 seconds	• Classmate 1 immediately clicked on 'Connect With Us' at the top of the page and pressed 'Contact Us' after. • Classmate 2 immediately scrolled to the bottom of the home page and selected 'Contact Us' under the header of 'Connect With Us' • Classmate 3 immediately scrolled to the bottom of the home page and selected 'Contact Us' under the header of 'Connect With Us'.
This was by far the easiest task for users, as the website made it very clear where contact information to reach the arena's team. It is also shown how the website follows similar formats of other websites, as finding contact information at the very bottom is a common feature.	

Conclusion:

Many participants shared a similar familiarity with this style of website before taking the test, which likely contributed to their ability to complete it in under 10 minutes. I believe that testing individuals with no prior experience using a site like this might yield slightly different results. Overall, it appears that the Houston Toyota Center website is user-friendly, thanks to its presentation in a familiar format. All buttons were easily accessible, and none of the participants encountered extreme difficulty navigating the site.

The biggest issues found however, were the 'Login'/'Insider Signup' buttons that created the most confusion. Simplifying 'Insider Signup' to just 'Sign Up' would be the best solution. Also, placing the seating chart maps under a category and header that relates more to it would help users out much more. Task 5 was by far the smoothest test as finding contact information to reach out to the Toyota Center team was placed in the common places most websites use.